Metro ticketing research findings

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To the Northbank Transit product team from Ravi Chen, research analyst. This fictional results memo summarizes one study. All counts and quotations below are invented for demonstration and describe passenger experiences, not a researcher's preferred questionnaire design.

Study scope

The illustrative study included 240 adult passengers who tried to buy a ticket in the past 30 days. Recruitment included unsuccessful attempts. These figures describe this fictional sample only; no population estimate or statistical significance claim is intended.

Purchase outcomes

Of 240 participants, 174 obtained the intended ticket, 18 obtained a different ticket, 42 did not obtain a ticket and 6 could not remember the outcome. The categories are mutually exclusive and sum to 240.

Among the 42 participants who did not obtain a ticket, 24 described a payment problem, 16 described uncertainty about fares and 9 described trouble signing in. Participants could report more than one problem, so these mentions must not be added as a total number of people.

Experience themes

Participants who were unsure of the fare often described comparing several similarly named products. The issue concerned the ticket information shown by the service, not response labels in a research questionnaire.

Fictional participant P041 said: I prefer to see the cheapest ticket first. P118 said: I want one page with every fare so I can compare them. These statements express different passengers' interface preferences; they do not establish the analyst's preference.

Several unsuccessful purchasers said they needed confirmation of whether a payment had gone through. Participants who spoke with staff sometimes received that reassurance, but these accounts do not establish a causal effect of staff contact.

Product followup

The product team will investigate clearer fare descriptions and payment-status messages. The next step is to examine a prototype with passengers who experienced an incomplete purchase.

This memo records findings and proposed product work. It does not prescribe survey length, scale design, option ordering, presentation layout or a reusable authoring style.

Limitations

The figures are invented. Even in a real study, this design would not by itself establish population incidence, causal effects or a single preference shared by all passengers. A low rating cannot show which interface element caused a problem.